



PTI

## Sports Minister launches mascot, logo of Asian Aquatics Championship

Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya launched the mascot Jalveer and the logo for the upcoming 11th Asian Aquatics Championship, scheduled to be held in Ahmedabad from September 28 to October 11.

The tournament will also serve as a qualification meet for the 2026 Asian Games.

Mandaviya was joined at the launch by officials from the Swimming Federation of India (SFI). The championship will be staged at the newly built Veer Savarkar Sports Complex, designed to Olympic standards, and will see participation from over 30 nations across multiple disciplines.

With more than 1,000 participants expected in Gujarat later this month, the event offers Indian swimmers a chance to perform before a home crowd.

Speaking on the occasion, Mandaviya said: "This championship marks a historic milestone for Indian aquatics, offering our athletes the opportunity to showcase their talent against the finest in Asia."

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## INDIAN PLAYGROUND

### SPORTOON



**1** India will host the 28th ITTF-ATTU Asian Table Tennis Team Championships at the Kalinga Stadium in Bhubaneswar from October 11 to 15. The Table Tennis Federation of India announced that the event will bring Asia's top paddlers to the Odisha capital. While Odisha previously hosted the 2019 Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships in Cuttack, this will be its first Asian-level table tennis event. At last year's Asian Championships in Kazakhstan, the Indian men's and women's teams won bronze medals in their respective events. In addition, the pair of Ayhika Mukherjee and Sutirtha Mukherjee claimed a historic bronze in the women's doubles.

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**2** Yusha Nafees and Rudra Singh emerged champions in the boys' and girls' Under-19 categories at the Indian Junior Open Squash Championships. Nafees, a member of India's bronze medal-winning squad at the Asian Junior Team Championships earlier this year, rallied to beat Rachit Shah in a five-game thriller to claim the title at the Rajasthan Squash Academy. In the girls' U-19 final, Rudra cruised past Vyomika Khandelwal in straight games.

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